Additional file 4: Table - Results of the critical appraisal

Author, year	**Critical appraisal**
Abraham et al., 2014 [60]	NICE[31]: pp: 3, p: 6, m: /, NA: 4, NR[a]: 4, p[#], m[?]
Ahrberg et al., 2014 [61]	NICE[31]: pp: 1, p: 7, m: 2, NA: 4, NR[a]: 3, m[#], m[?]
Andruszkow et al., 2013 [42]	NICE[31]: pp: 2, p: 7, m: 1, NA: 4, NR[a]: 3, m[#], m[?]
Archer et al., 2012 [62]	NICE[31]: pp: 3, p: 6, m: 1, NA: 5, NR[a]: 2, p[#], m[?]
Attenberger et al., 2012 [47]	NICE[31]: pp: 3, p: 6, m: 1, NA: 5, NR[a]: 2, p[#], m[?]
Baranyi et al., 2010 [63]	NICE[31]: pp: 7, p: 3, m:/ , NA: 4, NR[a]: 3, pp[#], p[?]
Bouman et al., 2017 [38]	NICE[30]: pp: 9, p: 7, m: 3, NA: /, NR[a]: 6, m[#], m[?]
Burghofer et al., 2005 [64]	NICE[31]: pp: 8, p: 2, m: 1, NA: 6, NR[a]: /, p[#], p[?]
Christensen et al., 2011 [65]	NICE[30]: pp: 5, p: 5, m: 2, NA: 10, NR[a]: 3, p[#], p[?]
Dienstknecht et al., 2013 [43]	NICE[31]: pp: 3, p: 6, m: 1, NA: 4, NR[a]: 3, m[#], m[?]
Frénisy et al., 2006 [66]	NICE[31]: pp: 3, p: 8, m: /, NA: 4, NR[a]: 2, p[#], m[?]
Gribnau et al., 2008 [34]	NICE[31]: pp: 2, p: 1, m: 2, NA: 7, NR[a]: 5, m[#], m[?]
Gross et al., 2010 [48]	NICE[31]: pp: 6, p: 4, m: 2, NA: 3, NR[a]: 2, p[#], p[?]
Gross and Amsler, 2011 [49]	NICE[31]: pp: 4, p: 6, m: 1, NA: 4, NR[a]: 2, p[#], p[?]
Gross et al., 2012 [50]	NICE[31]: pp: 6, p: 5, m: /, NA: 4, NR[a]: 2, p[#], m[?]
Hldaki et al., 2009 [67]	NICE[31]: pp: 2, p: 2, m: 4, NA: 6, NR[a]: 3, m[#], m[?]
Holtslag et al., 2006 [53]	NICE[31]: pp: 3, p: 7, m: 1, NA: 4, NR[a]: 2, p[#], p[?]
Holtslag et al., 2007a [51]	NICE[31]: pp: 8, p: 2, m: /, NA: 5, NR[a]: 2, p[#], p[?]
Holtslag et al., 2007b [52]	NICE[31]: pp: 8, p: 1, m: /, NA: 5, NRa: 3, p#, p?

Author, year	**Critical appraisal**
Holtslag et al., 2008 [54]	NICE[31]: pp: 5, p: 8, m: /, NA: 4, NRa: /, pp#, pp?
Jackson et al. 2007 [68]	NICE[31]: pp: 5, p: 7, m: /, NA: 4, NR[a]: 1, p[#], p[?]
Kaske et al., 2014 [69]	NICE[31]: pp: 2, p: 5, m: 2, NA: 6, NR[a]: 2, m[#], m[?]
Lefering et al., 2012 [39]	SIGN[32]: y: 8, n: 3, cs: 2, p*: 1, da: 1
Lippert-Grüner et al., 2007 [70]	NICE[31]: pp: 3, p: 4, m: 1, NA: 4, NR[a]: 5, p[#], m[?]
Livingston et al., 2009 [71]	NICE[31]: pp: 1, p: 8, m: 1, NA: 4, NR[a]: 3, m[#], m[?]
Marasco et al., 2015 [37]	NICE[31]: pp: 6, p: 4, m: /, NA: 4, NR[a]: 3, p[#], p[?]
Mc Carthy et al., 2006 [35]	NICE[31]: pp: 9, p: 3, m: /, NA: 5, NR[a]: /, pp[#], p[?]
Ouellet et al., 2009 [55]	NICE[31]: pp: 6, p: 6, m: 1, NA: 3, NR[a]: 1, p[#], p[?]
Overgaard et al., 2011 [72]	NICE[31]: pp: 5, p: 8, m: 1, NA: 3, NR[a]: /, m[#], m[?]
Post et al., 2006 [11]	NICE[31]: pp: 3, p: 8, m: /, NA: 4, NR[a]: 2, p[#], p[?]
Probst et al., 2010 [44]	NICE[31]: pp: 5, p: 5, m: 2, NA: 4, NR[a]: 1, p[#], p[?]
Quale et al., 2009 [73]	NICE[31]: pp: 4, p: 4, m: 1, NA: 4, NR[a]: 4, pp[#], m[?]
Renovell-Ferrer et al., 2017 [74]	NICE[31]: pp: 1, p: 9, m: 1, NA: 2, NR[a]: 5, m[#], m[?]
Richter et al., 2006 [75]	NICE[31]: pp: 5, p: 4 m: 2, NA: 4, NR[a]: 2, m[#], m[?]
Ringburg et al., 2011 [1]	NICE[31]: pp: 6, p: 6, m: /, NA: 4, NR[a]: 1, p[#], p[?]
Sampalis et al. 2006 [76]	NICE[31]: pp: 6, p: 7, m: 1, NA: 3, NR[a]: /, p[#], p[?]
Schmidt-Rohlfing et al., 2011 [45]	NICE[31]: pp: 1, p: 4, m: 3, NA: 5, NR[a]: 4, m[#], m[?]
Simmel et al., 2013 [57]	NICE[31]: pp: 8, p: 3, m: /, NA: 4, NR[a]: 2, p[#], p[?]
Sirois et al., 2009 [56]	NICE[31]: pp: 5, p: 5, m: /, NA: 4, NR[a]: 3, p[#], p[?]

Author, year	**Critical appraisal**
Sluys et al., 2005 [77]	NICE[31]: pp: 5, p: 6, m: 3, NA: 3, NR[a]: /, m[#], m[?]
Soberg et al., 2007 [59]	NICE[31]: pp: 8, p: 2, m: /, NA: 5, NR[a]: 2, p[#], p[?]
Soberg et al., 2011 [58]	NICE[31]: pp: 7, p: 6, m: /, NA: 3, NR[a]: 1, p[#], p[?]
Stulemeijer et al., 2006 [78]	NICE[31]: pp: 3, p: 7, m: /, NA: 5, NR[a]: 2, p[#], m[?]
Suzuki et al., 2007 [79]	NICE[31]: pp: 4, p: 9, m: 1, NA: 3, NR[a]: /, p[#], m[?]
Tee et al., 2014 [80]	NICE[31]: pp: 7, p: 3, m: /, NA: 4, NR[a]: 3, p[#], m[?]
Van Delft-Schreurs et al., 2016 [81]	SIGN[32]: y: 7, n: 1, cs: 5, p*: 1, si: 1
Victorson et al., 2008 [82]	MMAT[33]: y: 8, n: 2, ct: 2
Vles et al., 2005 [7]	NICE[31]: pp: 5, p: 6, m: 3, NA: 3, NR[a]: /, p[#], m[?]
von Rüden et al., 2013 [40]	NICE[31]: pp: 3, p: 5, m: 2, NA: 4, NR[a]: 3, m[#], m[?]
Williamson et al., 2009 [83]	NICE[31]: pp: 7, p: 3, m: /, NA: 4, NR[a]: 3, p[#], p[?]
Wurm et al., 2012 [41]	NICE[31]: pp: 3, p: 5, m: 1, NA: 5, NR[a]: 3, m[#], m[?]
Zelle et al., 2005a [46]	NICE[31]: pp: 4, p: 6, m: 1, NA: 4, NR[a]: 2, m[#], m[?]
Zelle et al., 2005b [36]	NICE[31]: pp: 8, p: 3, m: /, NA: 4, NR[a]: 2, p[#], p[?]
Zwingmann et al., 2016 [84]	NICE[31]: pp: 3, p: 3, m: 4, NA: 5, NR[a]: 2, m[#], m[?]

Abbreviations:

n: no; y: yes

MMAT: ct: can´t tell – statement not possible;

NICE: m: there are significant sources of bias.; m[#]: Evaluation of internal validity of entire study – few or no checklist criteria were fulfilled; m[?]: Evaluation of the study's overall external validity – few or no checklist criteria were fulfilled; NA: not applicable – aspects of the study design that are not applicable; NR[a]: not reported – the study does not report how certain aspects have been or should have been taken into account; p: either the checklist question cannot be clearly answered by the way the study is reported, or the study may not have considered all potential sources of bias; p[#]: Evaluation of internal validity of entire study – some checklist criteria were fulfilled; p[?]: Evaluation of the study's overall external validity – some checklist criteria were fulfilled; pp: study was designed or conducted to minimize risk of bias; pp[#]: Evaluation of the study's overall internal validity – all or most checklist criteria were fulfilled; pp[?]: Evaluation of the study's overall external validity – all or most checklist criteria were fulfilled.

SIGN: cs: can´t say– statement not possible; da: study directly applicable to target population; p*: Most criteria met. Some flaws in study with an associated risk of bias; si: some indirectness in applicability to target population.